systems and procedures in place to run the organisation and its activities. It had a shura (consultative body), a seniority list of its leaders, a promotion policy, system of election of its Amir (Chief), media policy, code of discipline, well-thought-out policies and strategies to carry out insurgency and terrorism.

It was reported that the TTP maintained a list of at least 15 senior-most leaders or commanders who were assigned important posts. The seniority was established on the basis of not only the length of time spent in the organisation but also the performance. Qari Walayat Mehsud was considered for the vacant slot of the chief of TTP after the death of Hakimullah Mehsud, although he stood eleventh on the seniority list. However, his performance was outstanding. He had reportedly masterminded the horrendous suicide attack on the Kohati Church in Peshawar in September 2013. The closeness and kinship with the core group of TTP leadership also played a role in giving seniority and assigning important posts.

Qari Walayat Mehsud was first cousin of Hakimullah Mehsud. However, he lost to Maulvi Fazlullah of Swat because he was considered a better choice by the TTP Majlis-e-Amla. The TTP's Majlis-e-Amla, comprising 15 members, voted for the election of the Amir (*The Nation*, 2013).

TTP IN SWAT

The militants operating in the Swat area of KP (formerly NWFP) were as destructive and brutal, if not more, as the main Waziristani TTP. They were headed by Maulvi Fazlullah, who was known as Maulvi FM for running unauthorised FM radio to propagate his militant views of 'imagined Islam' (*Dawn*, 2009). Their strength was estimated to be 3,000 (Democracy News Analysis, 2009) to 5,000 (*The News International*, 2009). They had been resorting to bombing, destroying schools or seizing them as their bases, beheading opponents and capturing security personnel (*The News International*, 2009).

Swat, a formerly princely state, is a picturesque valley in the north-west of Pakistan. It falls in the Malakand Division of the North-West Frontier Province but is a settled area and is not part of FATA. Unlike Waziristan, it shares no border with Afghanistan. Its population is approximately three million. It is only 160 km (80 miles) away from